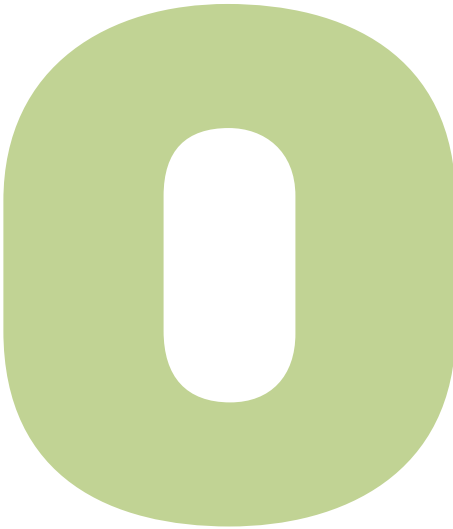




ne of the prime reasons for fear of Linux in the hearts of new users is the look and feel of an operating system.

Although Ubuntu has been using Gnome as its environment every since its inception, the new version, Natty Narwhal has brought something new to the table – Unity. Unity is an interface which was used in the ‘netbook’ edition by the Ubuntu team before they thought of making it simpler. When they did, they integrated both, Gnome and Unity interfaces into one distribution which could be used on Desktop PC’s & Laptops as well as Netbooks and other smaller screen devices.

The new Unity look

Unity was designed by the Ubuntu team to make Ubuntu easier than it already was. While some say that it doesn’t make it easy but even more difficult, others who love it term the difficulty to be a learning curve. When looking from a neutral point of view, we find it has both, good and bad impacts on the system.

The Gnome interface has (or had) two panels – one at the top and another at the bottom, with the bottom working as the taskbar and the top panel containing system menus, toolbar icons, quick launch buttons and in case of Ubuntu, a power button which could be used to control the shutdown,